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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION OCT 2025

THIRD SEMESTER

DISCIPLINE SPECIFIC COURSE COURSE (DSC)-MG3DSCMLM200

UNDERSTANDING FICTION

(2024 ONWARDS)

ANSWER SCHEME

Duration: 2hrs Max Marks: 70

PART A

1. Plot organizes events into meaningful sequences. The order of events in the story and usually follows a particular structure like five acts (Freytag's Pyramid).
2. A script is a written blueprint that combines dialogue, action, and description to shape characters, their journeys, and emotional arcs within a dramatic structure. Its primary purpose is to tell a compelling story that engages and emotionally resonates with audiences.
3. One Gandhian influence on fiction is the focus on truth, nonviolence, and moral integrity, as seen in R.K. Narayan's Waiting for the Mahatma.
4. Regional languages in fiction bring authenticity and cultural depth, capturing local traditions, values, and ways of life. They help preserve and celebrate regional identities, allowing readers to connect deeply with the culture portrayed.
5. A literary technique that presents a character's thoughts, feelings, and memories in a continuous flow, often without logical order or punctuation. Eg: James Joyce's Ulysses - blurs the line between conscious thought and subconscious feeling.
6. Set in pre-independence India, *Balyakalasakhi* tells the touching story of Majeed and Suhra, whose childhood friendship grows into love but is thwarted by social barriers and fate.
7. The central topic or idea, often a single word like "love" or "death," that a work is about. It conveys the underlying meaning or opinion about the subject, providing a central idea or insight about human nature.

PART B

8. Classical works offer profound and timeless reflections on the human experience, making them extremely relevant even today. They continue to inspire reflection, cultural understanding, and creativity, offering insights that resonate across generations. Classical literature remains relevant due to its exploration of

a) Universal Human Experiences : eg- Shakespeare's tragedies with human flaws resonate with contemporary audiences facing similar challenges. b) Timeless Moral and Ethical Dilemmas: How classical texts grapple with fundamental questions of right and wrong, power, justice and responsibility. c) Foundational Narratives and Cultural Influence: eg- Greek mythologies.

9. A crucial and complex element that dictates the narrative perspective. It determines who is telling the story, to whom it's being told, the form of the narrative, the narrator's distance from the action, and any limitations the narrator might have. Point of View significantly influences character development by shaping how readers perceive and understand characters' thoughts, motivations, and actions. For instance, a first-person perspective allows readers to experience a character's internal struggles and emotions directly, fostering a deeper emotional connection. In contrast, a third-person omniscient viewpoint provides a broader understanding of multiple characters, which can create complexity in character relationships and motivations.
10. Bengali literature reflects the human and social upheavals caused by1947 Partition, por traying characters grappling with forced migration, disrupted identities, and psychologi cal trauma. Novels frequently explore communal violence, cultural fragmentation, and longing for a lost homeland, while also serving as historical testimony and ethical inqu iry into human responses to crisis. Through innovative narrative forms and thematic de pth, these works document both personal and collective experiences, bridging past and present. Influential texts like Setu, Shiuli, Chitra Nodir Pare, and Padma Nadir Majhi il lustrate the enduring legacy of Partition, highlighting resilience, adaptation,and the nua nced consequences of geopolitical upheaval on Bengali society and literature.
11. Irony is a literary device in which contradictory statements or situations reveal a reality that is different from what appears to be true. There are many forms of irony featured in literature. The effectiveness of irony as a literary device depends on the reader's expectations and understanding of the disparity between what "should" happen and what actually happens in a literary work. One of the most famous examples of irony in literature comes from *the gift of the Magi* by O. Henry. At its core, irony emerges from the contrast between what seems to be and what actually is. This fundamental tension creates a cognitive dissonance that engages readers on multiple levels, forcing them to look beyond surface meanings and consider deeper implications. Three types of irony are Verbal irony, Situational and Dramatic irony.
12. Setting is where and when the story takes place. Setting helps create mood, influence characters' behavior, and reflect cultural values. The geographical location including the city, state, country, and possibly even the universe, if the writer is writing science fiction. Writers use setting to reflect cultural values by embedding traditions, beliefs, and social norms into the physical and social environment of their stories. The choice of location, time period, and atmosphere helps convey how characters interact with their world and what their society values. Settings like villages, cities, or historical eras can highlight themes such as community, resistance, or modernization. Cultural details—like architecture, rituals, and language—immerse readers in a specific worldview and reveal

deeper meanings. Ultimately, setting becomes a lens through which readers understand the cultural identity and moral fabric of a story's world.

13. Adapting a novel into a screenplay involves creative transformation rather than direct translation. The source material serves as inspiration, not a script to copy word-for-word. Since novels rely on inner thoughts and narration, screenwriters must express these through visuals, actions, and dialogue. The process requires condensing the story, removing unnecessary subplots, and keeping the script focused and concise. Ultimately, dialogue and scenes are reshaped to suit the cinematic medium, emphasizing brevity, subtext, and emotional impact.
14. In Midnight's Children, Salman Rushdie uses magic realism as a key postcolonial tool to connect personal and national histories. The technique blends magical elements with realistic settings to reflect India's complex post-independence identity. Through Saleem Sinai and the other "midnight's children," Rushdie symbolizes the nation's diversity and transformation. By merging history, myth, and fantasy, he challenges Western notions of historical truth. Ultimately, this fusion affirms an Indian storytelling tradition that unites the personal, political, and mythical.
15. Romance explores the growth of a relationship between characters who face various obstacles before finding love. Internal conflicts like fear, pride, or trust issues reveal emotional depth and foster self-discovery. External challenges such as social barriers or family opposition test the lovers' strength and commitment. These struggles shape the characters' emotional and moral growth, making their love journey more authentic. Ultimately, the conflicts drive the story's climax and resolution, leading to a meaningful and satisfying conclusion.

PART C

16. The temporal narrative structure in fiction refers to the arrangement of events in time as they are narrated, shaping the reader's understanding of plot, suspense, and character growth. It can be linear, following chronological order, or nonlinear, using techniques like flashbacks, flash-forwards, and time loops. Flashbacks reveal past events, while flash-forwards hint at future outcomes. Stories that begin in medias res start in the middle of action and reveal earlier events gradually. Some narratives use circular time, where events repeat or the ending mirrors the beginning. A linear narrative presents events in chronological order, creating a smooth pace and clear character growth as the story builds toward its climax. Suspense develops naturally as readers anticipate upcoming events. In contrast, a nonlinear narrative rearranges time through flashbacks or shifts, altering pacing and deepening emotional impact. This structure builds suspense by revealing information gradually and enhances character depth by uncovering hidden pasts or future outcomes.
17. The Mahabharata, written by Vyasa, is the world's largest epic poem with about 100,000 verses. It tells the story of the Kurukshetra War between the Pandavas and Kauravas, exploring themes of duty, righteousness, and moral conflict. Divided into 18 books, it contains numerous sub-stories and the Bhagavad Gita, a dialogue between Arjuna and Krishna. The epic concludes with the 18-day war, marked by immense destruction and deep ethical dilemmas. The Mahabharata uses nonlinear storytelling through multiple

timelines and stories within stories. Narrators shift between past, present, and future, creating a layered narrative structure. Flashbacks and embedded tales enrich the main plot with moral and spiritual insights. Prophecies and divine visions act as flash-forwards, revealing future events. This nonlinear form highlights the cyclical nature of time and deepens the epic's philosophical and emotional impact.

18. Drama is a literary genre meant for performance, using dialogue and action to tell a story. It relies on actors, stage directions, and visual elements to portray characters and conflicts. Divided into acts and scenes, it builds tension and develops the plot. Through performance, drama explores human emotions and relationships, blending literature with theatre for an engaging experience.Drama is uniquely crafted for live or recorded performance, with scripts that emphasize dialogue, action, and stage directions to guide actors and directors. It relies heavily on visual and auditory elements such as costumes, lighting, and sound to create atmosphere and convey emotion. Characters are designed to be embodied by performers, allowing audiences to experience their conflicts and transformations in real time. The structure of drama, including acts and scenes, supports pacing and dramatic tension suited for theatrical or cinematic presentation.

19. Answer should include a thriller short story in the proper structure which evoke excitement, suspense, and a sense of constant danger. To apply the concept of rising action in designing tension for a thriller, the writer should build suspense gradually through a series of escalating conflicts and revelations. Each event should raise the stakes, deepen the mystery, or place the protagonist in greater danger. Clues, red herrings, and unexpected twists can keep the audience guessing and heighten emotional intensity. The pacing should quicken as obstacles grow more threatening, pushing the story toward the climax.